City of Cambridge

POR 2026-174
FIRST IN COUNCIL
September 28, 2026

COUNCILLOR MCGOVERN
COUNCILLOR SOBRINHO-WHEELER
VICE MAYOR AZEEM
COUNCILLOR AL-ZUBI

WHEREAS: The City of Cambridge is one of the most densely populated cities in Massachusetts, where residents live, walk, and bike along narrow, historic streets that already carry heavy volumes of commercial truck traffic on corridors such as Massachusetts Avenue, Memorial Drive, and Route 2; and

WHEREAS: Congress is considering H.R. 8870, the BUILD America 250 Act, which includes an amendment creating a ten-year pilot program that would allow trucks weighing 91,000 pounds, 11,000 pounds over the current federal limit, onto interstate highways and the local roads that connect to them; and

WHEREAS: The City of Cambridge adopted a Vision Zero policy in 2016 and later passed its own Cambridge Truck Safety Ordinance requiring side guards and additional mirrors on large trucks operating in the city, a measure taken directly in response to cyclists killed in collisions with trucks on Cambridge streets, showing how seriously this City already takes the danger posed by large commercial vehicles; and

WHEREAS: Middlesex County, home to Cambridge, recorded 480 large truck crashes in 2024 alone, resulting in 5 deaths and 226 injuries, and of the county's 821 bridges, 91 are rated in poor condition (FMCSA/NHTSA/FHWA); and

WHEREAS: Statewide, Massachusetts recorded 2,150 large truck crashes in 2024, resulting in 32 deaths and 1,236 injuries. Of the Commonwealth's 5,311 bridges, over 76 percent have been rated in poor/fair condition by the Federal Highway Administration (FHWA), giving Massachusetts the second smallest share of bridges rated in good condition of any state in the country; and

WHEREAS: A statewide local bridge study conducted by CABT and county engineers from around the country found that 266 local, non-interstate bridges would be put at risk of needing replacement at a cost of more than $2.2 billion if 91,000-pound trucks were allowed on the road (FHWA); and

WHEREAS: The United States Department of Transportation's own research has found that heavier trucks require significantly longer distances to stop and are involved in crashes at substantially higher rates than trucks operating at the current 80,000-pound limit; and

WHEREAS: The National League of Cities and the United States Conference of Mayors are among the national organizations that have joined law enforcement, safety, and infrastructure groups across the country in opposing any increase to federal truck size or weight limits; now therefore be it

ORDERED: That the Cambridge City Council go on record opposing any federal legislation, including H.R. 8870 and the BUILD America 250 Act, or any pilot program that would increase truck weight or length limits on the Interstate Highway System or impose these larger configurations on Massachusetts' infrastructure; and be it further

ORDERED: That the Cambridge City Council call on Congress to prioritize public safety, protect local authority over local roads and bridges, and reject any increase in truck size or weight limits; and be it further

ORDERED: That the Cambridge City Council urge Congress to restore and strengthen, rather than reduce, funding for federal motor carrier safety enforcement; and be it further

ORDERED: That the City Clerk be and hereby is requested to forward a suitably engrossed copies of this resolution to Senator Elizabeth Warren, Senator Edward J. Markey, Representative Katherine Clark, and Representative Ayanna Pressley on behalf of the entire City Council.

A true copy;

ATTEST:- Paula M. Crane

Paula M. Crane,
Interim City Clerk

City of Cambridge

City Council opposition to H.R. 8870 and Increases in Federal Truck Size and Weight Limits.